Zachary Elkins

Department of Government, University of Texas at Austin
158 W. 21st St. Stop A1800
Austin, TX 78712-1704
zelkins@austin.utexas.edu

Education

2003 PH.D in Political Science, University of California, Berkeley.
Designed by Diffusion: International Networks and the Spread of Democracy. Advisors: David Collier (Chair), Beth Simmons, Henry Brady, Ruth Berins Collier, Trond Petersen.

1996 M.A. in Government, University of Texas at Austin
The Consequences of Mandatory Voting in Brazil. Advisors: Henry Dietz and Lawrence Graham

1992 B.A. in Philosophy, Yale University, New Haven, CT.
Existentialism and Psychiatry. Advisor: Maurice Natanson.

Professional Appointments

2024-present *Professor*, Department of Government, University of Texas at Austin

2010-2024 *Associate Professor*, Department of Government, University of Texas at Austin

2008-present *Faculty Affiliate*: (1) Lozano Long Institute of Latin American Studies; (2) Human Dimensions of Organizations; (3) School of Law

2008-2010 *Assistant Professor*, Department of Government, University of Texas at Austin

2003-2008 *Assistant Professor*, Department of Political Science, University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign, IL
Faculty Affiliate: (1) Center for Latin American and Caribbean Studies and (2) Cline Center for Advanced Social Research;

Publications and Creative Works

Books

Forthcoming 3. Elkins, Zachary. *Steal this Constitution: Essays in the Drift and Mastery of Constitutional Design.* | Summary.

Forthcoming 2. Elkins, Zachary (Ed.). *Working with Concepts: Foundational Essays by David Collier, with Research Notes on Innovation in the Field*. New York: Cambridge University Press.

2009 1. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton. The Endurance of National Constitutions. New York: Cambridge University Press. (Preview Chapter One).

Peer-reviewed Journal Articles

2024 29. Chilton, Adam, Mila Versteeg, many others, and Zachary Elkins. "Which Constitutional Provisions are the most Important?". *European Journal for Empirical Legal Studies* 1 (1).

2023 28. Cruz, Andres Cruz, Zachary Elkins, Roy Gardner, Matt Martin, and Ashley Moran. "Measuring constitutional preferences: A new method for analyzing public consultation data." *PLOS One.*

2022 27. Elkins, Zachary and Tom Ginsburg. "Ideation and Innovation in Constitutional Rights." *Journal of Law and Ethics of Human Rights* 16(2): 217-244.

26. Elkins, Zachary and Tom Ginsburg. "On Disruption and Leximetrics." *International Journal of Constitutional Law* 19(5): 1835-41.

25. Elkins, Zachary. "Underestimated but Undeterred: The 27th Amendment and the Power of Tenacious Citizenship." *Political Science and Politics* 56(1): 158-163.

24. Elkins, Zachary and Tom Ginsburg. "Imagining a World without the Universal Declaration of Human Rights." *World Politics* 74(3): 327-366.

2021 23. Elkins, Zachary and Svitlana Chernykh. "How Constitutional Drafters Use Comparative Evidence." *Journal of Comparative Policy Analysis* 24(6): 529-556.

22. Elkins, Zachary. "Militant Democracy and the Pre-emptive Constitution: From Party Bans to Hardened Term Limits." *Democratization* 29(1): 174-198.

21. Elkins, Zachary and Tom Ginsburg. "What Can We Learn from Written Constitutions?" *Annual Review of Political Science* 24: 321-343.

20. Cozza, Joseph, Zachary Elkins, and Alex Hudson. "Reverse mortgages and aircraft parts: The arcane referendum and the limits of citizen competence." *Electoral Studies* 74.

19. Elkins, Zachary. "Term Limit Evasions and the Non-Compliance Cycle." *Constitutional Political Economy* 32: 326–345.

18. Jacobs, Alan, Tim Buthe [core authors], and many others including Zachary Elkins. "The Qualitative Transparency Deliberations: Insights and Implications." *Perspectives on Politics.*

17. Elkins, Zachary, Scott Spitzer, and Jonas Tallberg. "Content Analysis." In Alan Jacobs and Tim Buthe (eds.). *Transparency in qualitative research.* [a symposium in *Perspectives on Politics*].

2020 16. Amick, Joe, Terrence Chapman, and Zachary Elkins. "On Constitutionalizing a Balanced Budget." *Journal of Politics* 82(3).

2019 15. Elkins, Zachary. "On the Paradox of State Religion and Religious Freedom" *Oxford Research Encyclopedia of Politics.*

2016 14. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton. "On the influence of Magna Carta and other cultural relics." *International Review of Law and Economics* 47: 3-9.

2014 13. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, James Melton, Robert Shaffer, Juan F. Sequeda, and Daniel P. Miranker. "Constitute: The world's constitutions to read, search, and compare." *Journal of Web Semantics* 27–28: 10-18.

2013 12. Cheibub, Jose Antonio, Zachary Elkins, and Tom Ginsburg. "Beyond Presidentialism and Parliamentarism." *British Journal of Political Science* 44(3): 515-544.

11. Elkins, Zachary."The Weight of History and the Rebuilding of Brazilian Democracy." *Lua Nova: Revista de Cultura e Política* 88: 257-303.

2012 10. Elkins, Zachary, James Melton, Tom Ginsburg, and Kalev Leetaru. 2012. "On the Interpretability of Law: Lessons from the Decoding of National Constitutions." *British Journal of Political Science* 43(2): 399-423.

9. Elkins, Zachary. "Diffusion and the Constitutionalization of Europe." *Comparative Political Studies* 43: 1-31.

2009 8. Ginsburg, Tom, Zachary Elkins, and Justin Blount. "Does the Process of Constitution-making Matter." *Annual Review of Law and Social Science* 5: 201-223.

2007 7. Elkins, Zachary and John Sides. Can Institutions Build Unity in Multiethnic States." *American Political Science Review* 101: 693-708.[Runner-up for the award of best article of 2007 awarded by the Comparative Democratization Section of APSA in 2008.]

2006 6. Elkins, Zachary, Beth Simmons*, and Andrew Guzman. "Competing for Capital: The Diffusion of Bilateral Investment Treaties, 1959-2000." " *International Organization* 60(4): 811-846. [Reprinted in: (1)Frank Dobbin, Beth Simmons, and Geoff Garrett (eds.) International Diffusion of Political and Economic Liberalization Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. Pp. 220-260; (2) Michael Waibel (ed.) *The Backlash against Investment Arbitration*, pp. 369-407; and (3)llinois Law Review 2008: 265-304, with data and analysis updated to 2006 along with an expanded discussion.]

2005 5. Elkins, Zachary and Beth Simmons*. "On Waves, Clusters, and Diffusion: A Conceptual Framework." *Annals of the American Academy of Political and Social Science* 598: 33-51.

2004 4. Simmons, Beth* and Zachary Elkins. "The Globalization of Liberalization: Policy Diffusion in the International Political Economy." " *American Political Science Review* 98: 171-190.

2003 3. de Figueiredo, Rui and Zachary Elkins. "Are Patriots Bigots? An Inquiry into the Vices of In-group Pride" *American Journal of Political Science* 47: 171-188.

2000 2. Elkins, Zachary. "Gradations of Democracy? Empirical Tests of Alternative Conceptualizations." *American Journal of Political Science* 44: 293-300.

1. Elkins, Zachary. "Quem Iria Votar? Conheçendo as Consequências do Voto Obrigatório no Brasil" *Opinão Pública* 6 (1): 111-137. [English title: "Who Would Vote? Understanding the Consequences of Mandatory Voting in Brazil"]

Non-peer-reviewed Articles and Chapters

Forthcoming 43. Elkins, Zachary. "Knowledge Representation in Comparative Law." in Diana Kapiszewski and Matthew Ingram (eds.) *Data and Methods in the Comparative Study of Legal Institutions.* Cambridge University Press.

2024 42. Elkins, Zachary and Tom Ginsburg. "Contrariness and Contradiction in Constitutional Law." In Ran Hirschl and Yaniv Roznai (eds.), *Deciphering the Genome of Constitutionalism: Essays on Constitutional Identity in Honor of Gary J. Jacobsohn.* Cambridge University Press.

2022 41. Elkins, Zachary. "How to Think Conceptually without Really Trying: Notes on the Teaching of Concept Analysis." In *Teaching Graduate Political Methodology*, edited by Mitchell Brown, Shane Nordyke, and Cameron Thies. Elgar.

40. Elkins, Zachary. "Effects of a Hard Commitment to Alternation in Power." *Texas International Law Journal* 57(3): 381-395.

39. Elkins, Zachary and Alex Hudson. "The Strange Case of the Package Deal: Amendments and Replacements in Constitutional Reform." in Richard Albert and Richard Stacey (eds.) *The Limits and Legitimacy of Referendums.* Oxford University Press.

2021 38. Elkins, Zachary. "The Mutualism of Human Rights Law and Interest Groups." The University of Chicago Law Review Online. Included in the symposium, *Measuring Impact in Constitutional Law*. Print version of the article here.

37. Elkins, Zachary. "Strong Citizens, Strong Presidents: The Architecture of the Inclusionary Turn in Latin America" in Diana Kapiszewski, Steven Levitsky, and Deborah Yashar (eds.) *The Inclusionary Turn*. Cambridge University Press.

36. Amick, Joe, Terrence Chapman, and Zachary Elkins. "How Historical Constitutional Data Informs Current Policy Debates." *The Political Economist*.

2020 35. Elkins, Zachary. "Concept Regulation in Political Science" in Bertrand Badie, Dirk Berg-Schlosser, and Leonardo Morlino (eds.), *The Sage Handbook of Political Science*.

34. Elkins, Zachary and Alex Hudson. "The Constitutional Referendum in Historical Perspective" in David Landau and Hanna Lerner (eds.) *Comparative Constitution Making*. Elgar

2019 33. Elkins, Zachary. "Is the Sky Falling? Constitutional Crises in Historical Perspective." in Mark Graber, Sandy Levinson, and Mark Tushnet (eds.) *Constitutional Democracy in Crisis?*. Oxford University Press.

32. Elkins, Zachary. "Constitutional Transition." in Roger Congleton, Bernie Grofman, and Stefan Voigt (eds.) *Oxford Handbook of Public Choice*. Oxford University Press.

31. Elkins, Zachary and Tom Ginsburg. "One Size Does not Fit All: The Provision and Interpretation of Presidential Term Limits." In Alexander Baturo and Robert Elgie (eds.) *The Politics of Presidential Term Limits*. Oxford University Press.

30. Baugher, Jessie, Zachary Elkins, and Tom Ginsburg. "Bringing Constitutions into the Classroom." *Social Education* 82(3):128–132, 154.

2017 29. Elkins, Zachary. "Constitutional Revolution in the Andes?" in Rosalind Dixon and Tom Ginsburg (eds.) *Comparative Constitutional Law in Latin America*. Elgar.

28. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg,and James Melton. "The Universal Declaration of Human Rights as Constitutional Model" in Keri E. Iyall Smith, Louis Edgar Esparza, Judith R. Blau (eds.) *Human Rights Of, By, and For the People: How to Critique and Change the US Constitution*.

2016 27. Elkins, Zachary. "The Logic and Design of a low-commitment Constitution (or, how to stop worrying about the right to secede)." in Sanford Levinson (ed.) *Nullification and Secession in Contemporary Constitutional Thought*.

26. Elkins, Zachary. "Comparative Approaches to Constitutional Gun Rights." In Glenn Howard Utter (ed.) *Guns and Contemporary Society: The Past, Present, and Future of Firearms and Firearm Policy*.

25. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton. "Time and Constitutional Efficacy." in Tom Ginsburg and Aziz Huq (eds.) *Assessing Constitutional Performance*. pp. 233-268.

24. Elkins, Zachary. "What do Constitution-Makers Say about Foreign Ideas? Lessons from Brazil. in Carlos Aurélio Pimenta de Faria, Denilson Bandeira Coêlho, and Sidney Jard da Silva (eds.), *Difusão de Políticas Públicas*. Editora UFABC: Sao Bernardo do Campo, SP, Brasil.

2014 23. Elkins, Zachary. "Measuring Partial Membership in Categories: Alternative Tools." *Qualitative and Multi-Method Research* 12(1).

22. Chernykh, Svitlana, Zachary Elkins, James Melton, Tom Ginsburg. "Constitutions and the Management of Elections." In Norris, P and Frank, RW and Martinez I Coma, F, (eds.) *Advancing Electoral Integrity.* Oxford: Oxford University Press.

21. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton. "The Content of Authoritarian Constitutions." In Tom Ginsburg and Alberto Simpser (eds) *Constitutions in Authoritarian Regimes.* Cambridge University Press.

2013 20. Elkins, Zachary."Comparability and the Analysis of National Constitutions." *APSA-CP Newsletter* 23(1).

19. Elkins, Zachary."When Constitutions Shape National Identity." *LASA Forum.*

18. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and Beth Simmons*. 2013."Getting to Rights: Treaty Ratification, Constitutional Convergence, and Human Rights Practice." *Harvard International Law Journal.*

2012 17. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton. "Comments on Law and Versteeg's 'The Declining Influence of the U.S. Constitution." *NYU Law Review.*

16. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton, "An epidemiological analysis of constitutional mortality," in Keith Whittington (ed.) *Law and politics : critical concepts in political science. V. 4, Comparative and international issues.* Princeton.

15. Cheibub, Jose, Zachary Elkins, and Tom Ginsburg. "Still the Land of Presidentialism? Executives and the Latin American Constitution," in Detlef Nolte and Almut Schilling (eds.). *New Constitutionalism in Latin America: Promises and Practices.* London: Ashgate.

14. Blount, Justin, Zachary Elkins, and Tom Ginsburg. "Does the Process of Constitution-Making Matter?" In Tom Ginsburg (ed.), *Comparative Constitutional Design.* Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. doi:10.1017/CBO9781139105712.016

13. Ginsburg, Tom, Elkins, Zachary, and Melton, James. "Do Executive Term Limits Cause Constitutional Crises?" In Tom Ginsburg (Ed.), *Comparative Constitutional Design.* Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. doi:10.1017/CBO9781139105712.016

2011 12. Cheibub, Jose, Zachary Elkins, and Tom Ginsburg. "Latin American Presidentialism in Comparative and Historical Perspective." *University of Texas Law Review* 89(7).

2010 11. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton. "On the Evasion of Executive Term Limits." *William and Mary Law Review* 52.

10. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton."Lessons from the Decoding and Coding of National Constitutions." *APSA-CD Newsletter* 9(1).

2009 9. Ginsburg, Tom and Zachary Elkins. "Ancillary Powers of Constitutional Courts." *University of Texas Law Review* 87: 1430-61.

8. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and Justin Blount. "The Citizen as Founder: Public Participation in Constitutional Approval." *Temple Law Review* 81(2): 361-382 [Published in Spanish in expanded form as,"Ciudadano Como Fundador: la Participacion Publica en el diseno constitutional," in Revista Latinoamericana de Politica Comparada 1: 119-153]

7. Cheibub, Jose Antonio and Zachary Elkins. "A Hibridização De Formas Constitucionais: A Constituição Brasileira De 1988 Em Uma Perspectiva Histórica." In *O Legislativo Brasileiro em Perspectiva Comparada.* Lucio Rennó and Magna Inácio, eds. Editora Editora UFMG. Pp. 55-77.

6. Elkins, Zachary. "Constitutional Networks." In Miles Kahler (ed.), *Networked Politics: Agency, Power, and Governance.* Ithaca, NY: Cornell University Press. Pp. 43-63.

2008 5. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton. "Military Occupations and their Constitutional Residue." *APSA-CP Newsletter* 19(2): 7-10.

4. Ginsburg, Tom, Svitlana Chernykh, and Zachary Elkins. "Commitment and Diffusion: How and Why National Constitutions Incorporate International Law." *Illinois Law Review* 101: 201-237.

3. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton. "Baghdad, Tokyo, Kabul…Constitution Making in Occupied States." *William and Mary Law Review* 49(4): 1139-1178.

2. Elkins, Zachary. "Is Democracy Contagious?" In Peter Nardulli (ed.) *International Perspectives on Contemporary Democracy.* University of Illinois Press. Pp. 42-62

2003 1. Elkins, Zachary and Beth Simmons*. Globalization and Policy Diffusion: Explaining Three Decades of Liberalization." In Miles Kahler and David A. Lake (eds.) *Globalizing Authority: Economic Integration and the Changing Structure of Governance.* Princeton, NJ: University of Princeton Press. Pp. 275-304.

Encyclopedia Articles

2010 1. Elkins, Zachary. "Constitutional Engineering." In Leonardo Morlino (ed.) *The International Encyclopedia of Political Science.* Sage.

Book Reviews

2023 3. Elkins, Zachary. Review of Donald L. Horowitz. Constitutional Processes and Democratic Commitment. (Yale University Press, 2021). In the *International Journal of Constitutional Law.*

2012 2. Elkins, Zachary. Review of Tulia G. Falleti's *Decentralization and Subnational Politics in Latin America* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) in *Perspectives on Politics.*

2005 1. Elkins, Zachary. Review of Marcus Kurtz's *Free Market Democracy and the Chilean and Mexican Countryside* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) in *Comparative Political Studies* 38: 330-332.

Policy Reports

2013 8. Melton, James, Zachary Elkins, and Tom Ginsburg. "Whither Scotland? An Evaluation of a Proposed Constitutional Plan."

2012 7. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton. "A Review of Iceland's Draft Constitution." (Translated into Icelandic.)

2011 6. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and Justin Blount. "Constitutional Reform in the English-Speaking Caribbean: Challenges and Prospects." SSRC Conflict Prevention and Peace Forum.

2009-2012 5. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and various graduate students. Some 75-or-so Option Reports prepared for constitutional drafters and originally posted on constitutionmaking.org, a pre-cursor to Constitute.

2005 4. Elkins, Zachary and Tom Ginsburg. "The Iraqi Draft Constitution in Comparative Perspective."

1998 3. Stiles, Jon, Jonathan Cohen, Zachary Elkins, and Frederick Gey. *Latino Demographic Data Book*. Berkeley, CA: California Policy Studies. 176pp.

1997 2. Cavalcanti, Maria, Zachary Elkins, Katherine Mock, and O'Neal Spicer. "Problems of Service Delivery in Brazilian Public Security Policy," *In Policymaking in a Redemocratized Brazil*, Volume 2: Public Policy and Social Exclusion. Austin, TX: University of Texas Press. Pp. 47-69.

1994 1. Elkins, Zachary and Adelaide Farrah. "Racing Toward a New Disabilities Strategy in the Americas." *Americas* 46 (4).

Selected Opinion Pieces

2022 9. Elkins, Zachary. "Checking in on the 'Embarrassing' Second Amendment: Lessons from Ukraine and Uvalde." Balkinization Blog.

2020 8. Elkins, Zachary. "Employees prefer diverse workplaces but struggle to create them on their own." *Medium.com*

2019 7. Elkins, Zachary. "Compared with what? How to read the Cuban constitutional reforms." *Medium.com*

6. Elkins, Zachary. "How Powerful is the U.S. President?" *Vox.com*

2017 5. Elkins, Zachary. "Obamacare is a conservative program." *Medium.com*

2015 4. Elkins, Zachary. "Can you fit an Constitution on an index card?" *Medium.com*

2013 3. Elkins, Zachary. "Rewrite the Second Amendment." *New York Times*, April 5, 2013. p. A23

2. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton. "Guns Truly are American Exceptionalism." *Bloomberg View*, March 7, 2013

2007-2011 1. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and Ran Hirschl. Co-founders and co-bloggers of the blog constitutionmaking.org [since merged with I-connect, Blog of the International Journal of Constitutional Law]. Example post [blog is disabled]

Teaching Resources

2023 2. Elkins, Zachary. "How Powerful is the American President?" in Lowi, T.J., Ginsberg, B., Shepsle, K.A., Ansolabehere, S., and Han. *American Government: Power and Purpose* 17th edition. WW Norton.

2019 1. Ambrose, JoEllen, Jessie Baugher, Zachary Elkins, and Tom Ginsburg. "Bringing the World's Constitutions into the Classroom: Constitute Teaching Guide." Chicago: American Bar Foundation.

Selected Online and Multimedia Projects

2014-present 5. *Rights Interactive: The Bill of Rights in Comparative Perspective.* Interactive infographics and visualizations installed in the gallery of the National Constitutions Center and online. Description | site.

2013-present 4. *Constitute: The World's Constitutions to Read, Search, and Compare*. Online at constituteproject.org.

2013-present 3. *The Constitution Imagery Project*. High-resolution images of Constitutional artifacts and photos. Previously online at imagine-constitutions.culturalspot.org, but now archived.

2005-present 2. *The Comparative Constitutions Project*. Data, reports, and infographics. Online at comparativeconstitutionsproject.org.

2006-2013 1. *constitutionmaking.org*. Resources for constitutional drafters, including analytical reports, an edited set of constitutions, and an online forum (blog) [Since split and merged with Constitute and I-Connect.]

Works in Progress

Books

In preparation 2. Elkins, Zachary. *Conceptualization and Measurement*. Outline.

1. Elkins, Zachary and Tom Ginsburg. *Hard Limits, Soft Landings: How and Why to Induce Rotation in Power*. Outline

Edited Books

Under contract 1. Collier, David* (author) and Zachary Elkins (editor). *Working with Concepts: Fundamentals of the Craft, with Commentaries on Innovation in the Field.* Cambridge University Press. Proposal | cover.

Articles

Under contract 25. Elkins, Zachary. "Digital Semantics: Formal Methods of Concept Analysis." Included in Zachary Elkins and David Collier* (eds.), *Working with Concepts: Fundamentals of the Craft, with Commentaries on Innovation in the Field.* Cambridge University Press.

24. Elkins, Zachary."Is the Sky Falling, Part II: Constitutional Crises in Historical Perspective." in Mark Graber, Sandy Levinson, and Mark Tushnet (eds.) *Constitutional Democracy in Crisis?* [second edition]. Oxford University Press.

Under revision 23. Elkins, Zachary and John Sides. "The Vodka is Potent, but the Meat is Rotten: Evaluating Equivalence across Contexts." Revise and Resubmit at *American Journal of Political Science.*

22. Elkins, Zachary and Jill Lepore. "The Public Appetite for Constitutional Amendment in the United States." Revise and resubmit at *Political Science Quarterly.*

Under review 21. Elkins, Zachary. "What would Sartori Do? Concept Analysis in the Digital Age." Submitted as part of a special issue on Giovanni Sartori to *Revue internationale de politique comparée.*

20. Elkins, Zachary. "Concept Mapping in Comparative Law." Submitted to *Perspectives on Politics.*

19. Elkins, Zachary and Tom Ginsburg. "Why US Presidents are anything *but* Imperial." Submitted to the *British Journal of Political Science.*

18. Elkins, Zachary. "Ostensions and the Micro-level Foundations of Policy Diffusion." Submitted to *Political Science Quarterly.*

In preparation 17. Elkins, Zachary. "On Language and Diffusion."

*Dissertation supervisor

16. Elkins, Zachary. "Elements of Inconsistency in Constitutional Design, Intended and Otherwise."

15. Elkins, Zachary. "Polarization, Gridlock, and Presidential Power."

14. Elkins, Zachary and Brian Gaines. "Showing Your Colors: Political Exhibitionism, Behavioral Patriotism, and Neighborhood Context"

13. Elkins, Zachary. "On Olives and Duckbill Platypi: Taxonomical Approaches to Partial Membership."

12. Elkins, Zachary and John Sides. "Citizenship Laws and Ethnic Group Incorporation."

11. Shaffer, Robert and Zachary Elkins. "On Measuring Textual Similarity."

10. Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton. "Some Considerations in Building Measures of Similarity."

9. Elkins, Zachary and Jill Lepore. "Political Scientists are from Mars, Historians are from Venus: Concept Integration in the Social Sciences."

8. Elkins, Zachary. "Scholarly Interventions in Constitution Making."

7. Elkins, Zachary, Roy Gardner, and Ashley Moran. "What do you work on? The conceptualization of intellectual products."

6. Elkins, Zachary. "Legal Transplants Against Culture."

5. Elkins, Zachary. "Legacies of Colonialism in Constitutional Architecture."

4. Elkins, Zachary. "Unbundling the Constitutional Referendum."

3. Elkins, Zachary. "What if Government were run as a business?: And who's in charge here, anyway?"

2. Elkins, Zachary. "The Psychology of Decay and Destruction. Or, Things I used to think Mattered."

1. Elkins, Zachary and Beth Simmons. "Constitutions as Land Surveys: How and Why do States Define Territory?"

Awards and Honors

2023 Elkins, Zachary. *Award for Excellent Teaching*, Government Department, University of Texas. First inaugural recipient.

2019 Listed in the Political Science 400. The 400 most cited Political Scientists, among active and emeritus faculty in the United States.

2015 Elkins, Zachary. *Best Comparative Policy Paper of 2014*, awarded by the APSA Public Policy Section. [awarded for "Micro-level Foundations of Diffusion Theory: Experimental Evidence"]

Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton. Best Free Reference Web Sites 2015 List (Emerging Technologies Section), awarded by the Reference and User Services Association of the American Library Association. [Awarded for *Constitute*]

2014 Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton. *Tribeca Disruptive Innovation Award*. [awarded for *Constitute*]

Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton. Kantar Information is Beautiful Awards Shortlist Nominee. Awarded for CCP's Timeline of Constitutions.

Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton. *Nominet Trust List: 100 Most Inspiring Examples of Social Innovation.* [awarded for *Constitute*]

2013 Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton. *Lijphart/Przeworski/Verba Prize* for Best Dataset awarded by the Comparative Politics Section of the American Political Science Association. [awarded for the *Comparative Constitutions Project*]

2012 Elkins, Zachary, Tom Ginsburg, and James Melton. *Innovating Justice Award*, awarded by the *Hague Institute for the Internationalization of Law* [awarded for constitutionmaking.org (now constituteproject.org)]

2012 Elkins, Zachary. *Distinguished University Lecturer*, University of Texas at Austin. Awarded by the School of Undergraduate Studies.

2009 *Best book of 2009*, awarded by the Comparative Democratization Section of APSA. [awarded for *Endurance of National Constitutions*]

2007 *Best article of 2007* (runner-up), awarded by the Comparative Democratization Section of APSA. [awarded for "Can Institutions Build Unity in Multiethnic States?"]

2006 *Graduate Mentor of the Year*, Department of Political Science, University of Illinois [Selected by the Political Science Graduate Student Association]

2002-2007 *List of Excellent Instructors as Rated by their Students*, University of Illinois [awarded if "course quality" and "Instructor Effectiveness" are both in the top 30 percent of University instructors]

2006 *Jon Tolman prize for best paper*, Brazilian Studies Association Conference (BRASA). [awarded for "Sources of Constitutional Reform in Brazil: The Role of Foreign Models"]

Research Funding

2024-25 "Nationality Laws and Migrant Integration: A Survey of Venezuelan Migrants in three Settings." University of Texas, Research and Creative Grant. $10,000

2023-2025 "Concept Integration in Comparative Law." *National Science Foundation* (SES 2315189). $450,000

2018-2020 "Constitute: Phase III." Account: 26-7704-55xx. Google Milestones. Google Inc. $200,000

2013-2016 "Rights Interactive." National Constitutions Center. Account: 26-6817-29xx. $82,000

2014-2015 "Arabic Constitute." International IDEA. Account: 26-6303-12xx $160,000

2012-2015 "Constitute: An Indexed Repository of Constitutional Text." Google Ideas (now Jigsaw). Account: 26-7702-49xx. $325,843

2022-2024 Fellow of the Clyde Rabb Littlefield Chair in Liberal Arts. Account: 26-1021-91xx. $120,000.

2013-2018 Fellow of the H. Malcolm Macdonald Chair in Constitutional and Comparative Law, University of Texas at Austin. $50,000.

2012 "Constitute: An Indexed Repository of Constitutional Text. IC2 Innovation Grant, IC2 (University of Texas). $25,000

2008 National Science Foundation – renewal of SES 0648288 ($95,000)

2007 US Institute of Peace ($26,000)

2007 National Science Foundation – SES 0648288 ($197,000)

2005 Fellow, Center for the Study of Democratic Governance, University of Illinois

2003,2004 University of Illinois Research Board Grants

2001 University of California, Berkeley Dissertation Writing Fellowship

2000 Boren Dissertation Fellowship

1999 Institute on Global Conflict and Cooperation (IGCC) Dissertation Fellowship

1998 Tinker Summer Grant for Research in Brazil

1997 Foreign Language and Area Studies (FLAS) Summer Fellowship for language training in Brazil

1996 Ford Foundation Summer Grant for Research in Brazil

1995 University of Texas Summer Grant for Research in Cuba

1991 Yale University Mellon Summer Grant for Research in Guatemala

Teaching

Undergraduate Courses

(1) *Comparative Constitutional Design*
(2) *The Politics of Development*
(3) *Comparative Political Behavior*
(4) *The Art and Science of Contracting*

Graduate Courses

(5) *Conceptualization and Measurement*
(6) *Comparative Constitutional Design*
(7) *Comparative Political Behavior*
(8) *Democracy and Democratization*
(9) *Law and Democracy*
(10) *Writing and Publishing in Political Science*
(11) *The Structure of Organizations*

Advising and Student-related Service (Since 2010)*

PhD Dissertations Supervised

2025 6. Matt Martin
2022 5. Joseph Cozza (Co-supervision with Gary Jacobsohn)
2021 4. Ashley Moran
2018 3. Alex Hudson
2017 2. Joe Amick
2016 1. Robert Shaffer

PhD Dissertation Committees

current 37. Guillermo Perez
2025 36. Maria Paz Avila
2024 35. Laura de Castro Quaglia
34. Diego Vega
2023 33. Kyle Shen
32. Siyun, Jiang
31. Abby Blass
2022 30. Ilana Rothkopf (Notre Dame University)
2021 29. Wenhui Yang
2020 28. Iasmin Goes
27. Stephen Joyce
2019 26. Carolina Moehlecke
2017 25. Giorleny Altamirano
2016 24. Mathew Rhodes-Purdy
23. Ryan Lloyd
22. Michelle Whyman
21. Tofigh Maboudi (American University)
2015 20. Riitta-Ilona Koivumaeki
19. Kevin Stuart

*All programs of study are in Government (Political Science) unless otherwise noted

18. Steven Brooke
17. Jonathan Kinkel
16. Gabriel Cardona-Fox (LBJ School of Public Affairs)
15. Anna Fruhstorfer (Humboldt University, Berlin)

2014 14. Allison White
13. Byung-Jae Lee
12. Gustavo Rivera
11. Rachel Sternfeld
10. Michelle Wolfe
9. Huseyin Alptekin

2013 8. Hector Ibarra-Rueda
7. Daniel Nogueira-Budny
6. Regina Goodnow

2012 5. Luis Camacho
4. Stephanie Holmsten

2011 3. Manuel Balán

2010 2. Chih Cheng Meng
1. Rodrigo Nunes

M.A. Thesis Supervision†

2023 8. Vincent Scotino (Human Dimensions of Organizations)

2022 7. Juan de la Cruz (Human Dimensions of Organizations)
6. Gabriel Granado (Human Dimensions of Organizations)

2021 5. Katherine Lummis (Human Dimensions of Organizations)

2020 4. Thomas Elliott
3. Barea Sinno

2019 2. Abe Barranca

2018 1. Thomas Conroy

Undergraduate Honors Thesis Supervision

13. Ella Crowson
12. Luke Anderson
11. Wyatt Rubey
10. Lindsay Feinstein
9. Juan Pope
8. Ava Mouton-Johnston
7. Grant Durow
6. Thomas Hayes
5. Anthony Douglas
4. Michael Martinez
3. Michael Patison
2. Christopher Schroeder
1. Carly Klein

Project Administration

2025-present Co-director (with Ashley Moran). Center for Law and Democracy.

2022-present Co-director (with Ashley Moran). Embedded Scholars Program.

†Excludes those who completed master's degrees en route to their PhD

2012-present Director, Constitute: An Indexed Repository of the World's Constitutions.
2010-present Co-editor (with Ran Hirschl and Tom Ginsburg). Book series on Comparative Constitutional Law and Policy, Cambridge University Press.
2008-2024 Co-director (with Dan Brinks). Working Group on Law and Democracy, University of Texas.
2005-present Co-director (with Tom Ginsburg and James Melton), Comparative Constitutions Project

Scholarly Presentations

Conference Participation

Yearly *American Political Science Association* (APSA)
Occasional *International Studies Association* (ISA)
International Society of Public Law (ICON-S)
Latin American Studies Association (LASA)
International Political Science Association (IPSA)
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)
Red para el Estudio de la Economía Política de América Latina (REPAL)

Invited Presentations (outside of Austin since 2013)‡

2025 University of Nebraska, Lincoln, NE
European University Institute, Florence, Italy
University of Milan, Milan, Italy
Câmara de Deputados, Brasilia, Brazil
Tel Aviv University, Tel Aviv, Israel
Stanford University, Palo Alto, CA (May and September)
University of Georgia, Athens, GA
Texas Tech University, Lubbock, TX
2024 University of Toronto, Toronto, CA
National Democratic Institute
Union College, Schenectedy, NY
Penn State University, College Station, PA
2023 International IDEA. Panama City
Universidad de Chile, Santiago, Chile
University of Chicago, Chicago, IL
Harvard University, Cambridge, MA
2020-2022 Various online presentations (pandemic)
2020 World Policy Analysis Center (meetings in Naivasha, Kenya)
2019 Procuradoria-Geral de Justiça, Belo Horizonte, Brazil
Universidad de Havana, Havana, Cuba
Universidad Catolica, Santiago, Chile
University of Chicago, Chicago, IL
College of William and Mary, Williamsburg, VA
2018 University of Chicago, Chicago, IL (Fall)
University of Chicago, Chicago, IL (Spring)
Indiana University, Bloomington, IN
University of Notre Dame, South Bend, IN
Universidad de Uruguay, Montevideo, UR (two-week mini course)
2017 University of Chicago, Chicago, IL

‡Based on limited, retrospective records — apologies for omissions

	American University of Cairo, Cairo, Egypt
	Georgetown University, Washington, DC
	Universidade Nova de Lisboa, Lisbon, Portugal
	Tilburg University, Tilburg, the Netherlands
	The Hague Institute for Global Justice, The Hague, the Netherlands
	University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI
	New York University, New York, NY
	Humboldt University, Berlin, Germany (meetings at the Wissenschaftskolleg)
	University of Houston, Houston, TX
2016	Max Planck Institute, Gottingen, Germany
	University of California, Berkeley, CA
	De Justicia, Bogota, Colombia
	Harvard University, Cambridge, MA
	University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, MN
	Princeton University, Princeton, NJ
2015	Universidade Federal de Minas Gerais, Belo Horizonte, Brazil
	Humboldt University, Berlin, Germany
	Universidad Los Andes, Bogota, Colombia
	Facultad Latinoamericana de Ciencias Sociales (FLACSO), Mexico City, Mexico
	Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México, Mexico City, Mexico
	National Constitutions Center, Philadelphia, PA
	Center for Interdisciplinary Research (ZiF), Bielefeld, Germany
	International Institute for Democracy and Electoral Assistance, The Hague, the Netherlands
	Benghazi University (meetings in Carthage, Tunisia)
	German Institute for Global and Area Studies (GIGA), Hamburg, Germany
	University of New Mexico, Albuquerque, NM
2014	University of Gottingen, Gottingen, Germany
	University of Iowa, Iowa, City
	UT College of Liberal Arts Alumni Event, New York City, NY
	University of California, Berkeley, CA
	National Constitutions Center, Philadelphia, PA
	Princeton University, Princeton, NJ
	Universidad Catolica, Santiago, Chile
	University of Notre Dame, South Bend, IN
2013	University of Bergen, Bergen, Norway
	United Nations General Assembly, New York City, NY
	University of California, Berkeley, CA
	Texas A&M University, College Station, TX
	American University, Washington, DC

Professional Service and Affiliations (since 2010)

University of Texas

various	Executive Committee, Government (2010-2011; 2012-2013; 2014-2015; 2015-2016; 2017-2018; 2020-2021; 2021-2022; 2023-2024)
2023-2024	Gender Studies Faculty Search Committee, Government
2021-present	Field Chair, Public Law, Government
2012-present	Committee on Undergraduate Fellowships, Institute of Latin American Studies
2012-present	Faculty Advisory Board Member, Human Dimensions of Organizations

2021-2022 American Politics Faculty Search Committee, Government
2020-2021 Methodology Faculty Search Committee, Government
2008-2014 Graduate Admissions, Government
2011-2013 Faculty Council
2011-2013 Faculty Council Committee on International Programs and Study Abroad (Chair)
2010-2012 Charlie Wilson Chair Search Committee, Government
2010 Centennial Speakers Committee, Government
2010 International Relations Faculty Search committee, Government

Discipline-wide Service

2015-present Chair, Research Committee on Concepts and Methods (IPSA)
2014 Chair, Best Dataset Award Committeee, Comparative Politics Section (APSA)
2012-2015 Advisory Board, Research Committee on Concepts and Methods (IPSA)
2013 Chair, Best Paper Award Committee, APSA Comparative Democratization Section
2012-present Advisory Board, Electoral Integrity Project
2010 MPSA Section Head

Reviewer

Occasional reviews since 2002 for, among others, *American Journal of Political Science; American Political Science Review; Journal of Politics; Political Psychology; International Organization; Journal of Peace Research; World Politics; Journal of Theoretical Politics; World Development; Political Behavior; Law and Society; Comparative Politics, Comparative Political Studies; Political Analysis; National Science Foundation; Perspectives on Politics.*

Languages and Foreign Experience

Languages

English (native); serviceable command of **Spanish** and **Portuguese** (extensive coursework and residency); once-competent but now fading ability in **French** (two years of college coursework); sub-conscious knowledge of **Latin** (five years of high-school coursework)

Experience

Born (resided as an infant) in Bogotá, Colombia. Field work and/or residency in Brazil, Guatemala, Spain, Cuba, Colombia, and Belize.
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